

Caiyi Shen

M.S. Student in Game Science and Design
Northeastern University

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Portfolio: seleneshen123.github.io

Education

Northeastern University

M.S. in Game Science and Design

09/2025 – 06/2027

Boston, MA, United States

University of Wisconsin-Madison

B.A. in Psychology; Certificate in Game Design

09/2021 – 08/2024

Madison, WI, United States

Project & Research

AXIS AI | Project Lead / Game Designer / 3D Artist

Northeastern University

03/2026 – Present

Boston, MA, United States

- Collaborating with a faculty advisor [Prof. Ann Cai](#) to develop [AXIS AI](#), a cross-disciplinary AI platform that converts multilevel course materials into interactive 3D game-based learning experiences.
- Building, uploading, and testing psychology, education, and game design-related modules with pre and post-learning assessments, AI-generated summaries, interactive activities, and backend analytics tracking user progress and engagement patterns.
- Secured Northeastern University's PEAK Fellowship, applied NEA Grants for Arts Projects.

Qi Lab | Research Assistant / Game Designer / Programmer

Northeastern University

07/2026 – Present

Boston, MA, United States

- Collaborating with [Prof. Zhenghan Qi](#) to develop pilot research of neural entrainment. Developed and piloted a child-friendly EEG neural entrainment paradigm for studying statistical learning in minimally verbal children with autism, adapting an existing adult experimental protocol for pediatric use.
- Built and refined the PsychoPy experiment pipeline, including synchronized auditory–visual stimulus presentation, LSL event markers for EEG recording, participant data logging, break/pause controls, and multiple congruent/incongruent experimental conditions.
- Designed low-distraction animated visual stimuli and synchronized animation cycles with speech rhythms to support audiovisual neural entrainment while maintaining experimental timing constraints.
- Collaborated with researchers to integrate naturally recorded speech stimuli, troubleshoot experimental workflows, and prepare the paradigm for pilot testing and future data collection.

Learning, Representations, & Technology Lab | Research Assistant

University of Wisconsin-Madison

07/2022 – 09/2022

Madison, WI, United States

- Assisted with research on game-based STEM learning and representational competencies in a 3D astronomy [education game](#).
- Observed playtesting sessions and documented learners' navigation patterns, verbal reasoning, confusion points, and interactions with astronomy-related visual representations.
- Organized participant feedback from playtesting to support qualitative review of learners' sense-making processes.
- Synthesized observation notes and transcripts into playtest summaries, helping identify usability barriers, conceptual misunderstandings, and instructional design improvements.

Psychology Clinic | Clinical Assistant

Peking University Sixth Hospital

06/2023 – 08/2023

Beijing, China

- Learned and supported the supervised administration of transcranial magnetic stimulation (TMS), repetitive TMS (rTMS), theta-burst stimulation, and transcranial direct-current stimulation (tDCS).
- Assisted with [electroencephalogram \(EEG\)-based visual-stimulus experiments](#) to exam phobic response.
- Studied clinical ethics and professional conduct in psychiatric care, including informed consent, confidentiality, patient privacy, professional boundaries, and patient-safety protocols.
- Gained exposure to gender-related mental health services, including culturally sensitive communication with transgender women seeking clinical documentation for gender-affirming hormone therapy.

UW Child Development Lab | Field Observer

University of Wisconsin-Madison

09/2023 – 02/2024

Madison, WI, United States

- Completed structured observations of preschool-aged children in a university child development laboratory setting.
- Observed peer interaction and social communication behaviors, including verbal initiation, turn-taking, joint attention, toy sharing, cooperative play, and responses to peers' social bids.
- Produced an analytical research essay synthesizing field observations with developmental psychology theories of preschool peer interaction, play-based learning, and early friendship formation.

Working Experience

Deeplight Games | Concept Artist & 2D Designer

09/2026 – Present

Generate @ Northeastern University

Boston, MA, United States

- Develop concept art and 2D visual designs for a client-commissioned 3D action roguelike, translating client requirements and creative direction into cohesive visual concepts aligned with gameplay and production goals.
- Design dungeon environments, level layouts, and maps, incorporating environmental storytelling, player navigation, branching pathways, and combat encounters to enhance gameplay and exploration.
- Conceptualize characters, bosses, and abilities, integrating character aesthetics, gameplay mechanics, and environmental elements to establish distinctive and consistent visual identities.
- Contribute to UI/UX concepts and visual assets, collaborating with multidisciplinary teams to refine designs based on client feedback, technical feasibility, and project scope.

Montessori Schooling | Teacher

08/2024 – 08/2025

If Montessori School

Houston, TX, United States

- Worked with preschool-aged children in a Montessori classroom, observing attention, learning engagement, social interaction, and responses to hands-on learning materials.
- Used developmentally appropriate and Montessori-informed strategies to support children’s autonomy, language development, self-directed exploration, and classroom participation.
- Developed a play-based Chinese character learning activity based on observed patterns in children’s visual attention, symbolic association, and interaction with learning materials.

Digital Media Content Creator

01/2024 – Present

NetEase Blizzard China Creator Partnership

Online

- Produce gaming, cosplay, and livestream for online audiences, growing a Douyin account to 20,000+ followers.
- Create Hearthstone-related videos through a creator partnership with NetEase Blizzard China, with one video reaching 1,000,000 views.
- Translate, adapt, and publish game design talks on Bilibili to make developer perspectives and interactive media concepts accessible to Chinese-speaking audiences.

Free Online Education Platform | Co-founder & Creative Director

08/2022 – Present

Schoolive Interactive

Online

- Co-founded a **Moodle-based educational platform** providing psychology, game design, and interactive media learning resources for Chinese-speaking students.
- Developed and organized course content with attention to instructional sequencing, learner accessibility, and clarity of psychological and design-related concepts.
- Directed development of an educational game project, integrating character design, narrative design, and gameplay mechanics to support learner engagement and interactive knowledge acquisition.

Skills

Game Development : Unity, Unreal Engine, Autodesk Maya, Blender, ZBrush, Substance Painter, QuadSpinner Gaea

Design & Media Tools: Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Premiere Pro

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Advanced), Japanese (Advanced)